converged with some of the mujahideen factions in the Northern Alliance to fight against the Taliban. Ultimately an accommodation was reached whereby the Taliban kept a wali, or regional governor, nearby, but did not gain control of the province.[29]

Despite their animosity toward the Taliban, the Salafis in Kunar were on good terms with al-Qaeda, as was Lashkar. Bin Laden had helped some of the Saudis who came to Kunar during the Afghan jihad to establish bases in Kunar, and as mentioned in Chapter 1 some of these Arabs later joined al-Qaeda.[30] The Saudis in Kunar also worked with Jamiat al-Dawa al-Quran wal-Sunna, which gave early support to the Markaz al-Dawa wal-Irshad and helped to train Lashkar recruits in the early 1990s. Later in the decade al-Qaeda and Lashkar shared a logistician: Abu Zubayda vetted recruits for both organizations, and, it should be noted, for other Pakistani outfits too.[31] Zubayda was based in Peshawar where he screened trainees and made logistical arrangements for their travel to Afghanistan. According to the 9/11 Commission's report, he had an 'agreement with bin Laden to conduct reciprocal recruiting efforts whereby promising trainees at the camps could be invited to join al Qaeda.'[32] Lashkar militants trained at camps that were under al-Qaeda's control and which allegedly were run in cooperation with the ISI.[33]

Although Lashkar had good relations with al-Qaeda, it had no major assets in Afghanistan and was not particularly close to the Taliban. The Deobandi groups, however, had deep ties to the Taliban. In addition to historic relations forged via the same madaris, Deobandi militants from Pakistan spilled blood alongside their Taliban brethren on the Afghan battlefield against the Northern Alliance. The Taliban also protected various Deobandi militants from the Pakistani authorities at times. For example, when Sipah-e-Sahaba Pakistan experienced a crackdown in 1998 following its massacre of hundreds of Shia, some of the group's leaders fled to Kabul where the Taliban offered sanctuary.[34] Finally, the Deobandi groups had significant assets in Afghanistan. JeM's Maulana Azhar spent much of his time in Kandahar, while HuJI had its central secretariat in Kabul and Kandahar. In addition to contributing foot solders to the Taliban, the Deobandi groups also had members serving in the Taliban administration. HuJI contributed three government ministers and twenty-two judges to the Taliban's administration and its amir, Qari Saifullah Akhtar, served as an